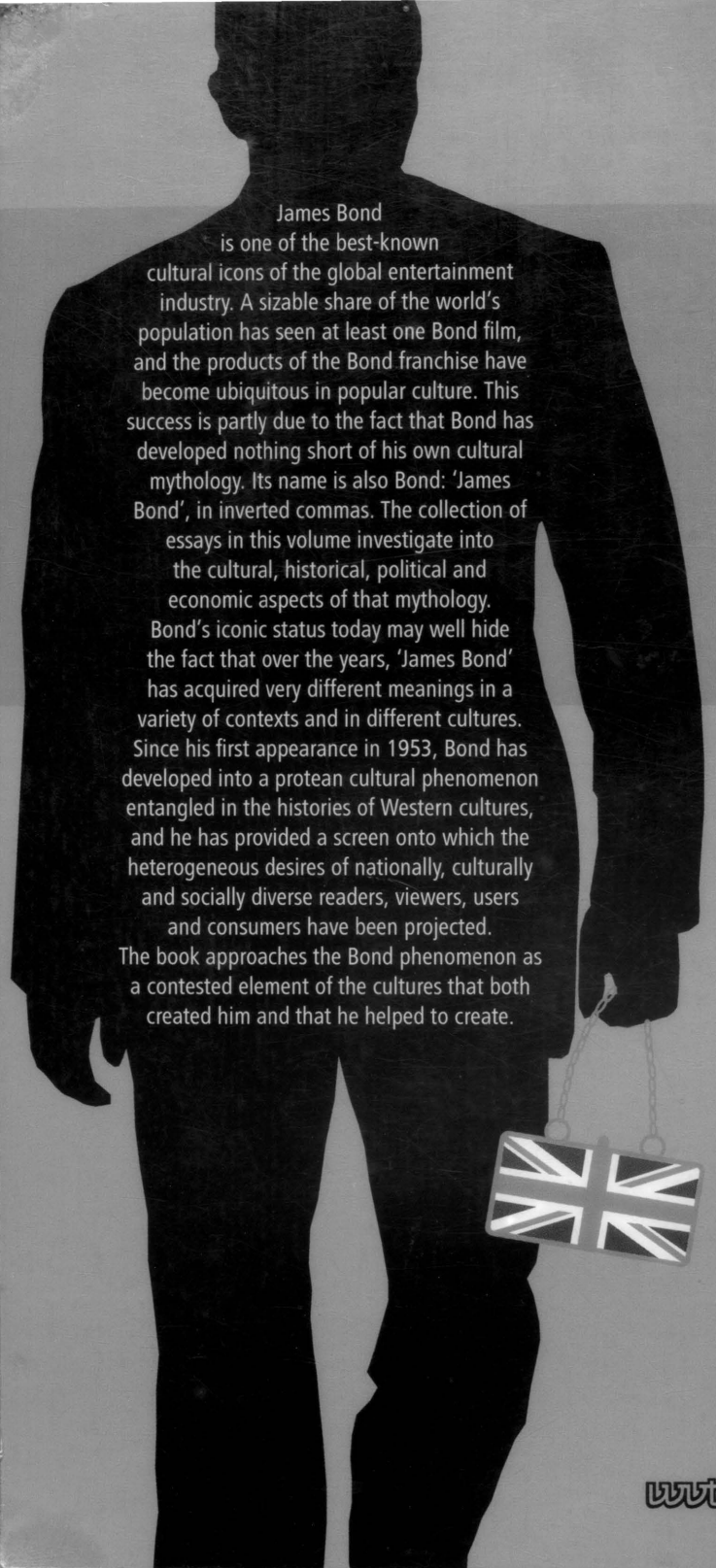




James Bond  
is one of the best-known  
cultural icons of the global entertainment  
industry. A sizable share of the world's  
population has seen at least one Bond film,  
and the products of the Bond franchise have  
become ubiquitous in popular culture. This  
success is partly due to the fact that Bond has  
developed nothing short of his own cultural  
mythology. Its name is also Bond: 'James  
Bond', in inverted commas. The collection of  
essays in this volume investigate into  
the cultural, historical, political and  
economic aspects of that mythology.  
Bond's iconic status today may well hide  
the fact that over the years, 'James Bond'  
has acquired very different meanings in a  
variety of contexts and in different cultures.  
Since his first appearance in 1953, Bond has  
developed into a protean cultural phenomenon  
entangled in the histories of Western cultures,  
and he has provided a screen onto which the  
heterogeneous desires of nationally, culturally  
and socially diverse readers, viewers, users  
and consumers have been projected.  
The book approaches the Bond phenomenon as  
a contested element of the cultures that both  
created him and that he helped to create.

WUT

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Joachim Frenk · Christian Krug (Eds.)

# The Cultures of **JAMES BOND**



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Joachim Frenk and Christian Krug (Eds.)

# **The Cultures of James Bond**

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Joachim Frenk, Christian Krug (Eds.). -

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## Abbreviations

|       |                                        |
|-------|----------------------------------------|
| CR    | <i>Casino Royale</i>                   |
| DAF   | <i>Diamonds Are Forever</i>            |
| DD    | <i>Die Another Day</i>                 |
| DN    | <i>Dr No</i>                           |
| FRL   | <i>From Russia with Love</i>           |
| FYEO  | <i>For Your Eyes Only</i>              |
| GE    | <i>GoldenEye</i>                       |
| GF    | <i>Goldfinger</i>                      |
| LK    | <i>Licence to Kill</i>                 |
| LLD   | <i>Live and Let Die</i>                |
| MGG   | <i>The Man with the Golden Gun</i>     |
| MR    | <i>Moonraker</i>                       |
| OHMSS | <i>On Her Majesty's Secret Service</i> |
| OP    | <i>Octopussy</i>                       |
| QS    | <i>Quantum of Solace</i>               |
| SLM   | <i>The Spy Who Loved Me</i>            |
| TB    | <i>Thunderball</i>                     |
| TLD   | <i>The Living Daylights</i>            |
| TND   | <i>Tomorrow Never Dies</i>             |
| VK    | <i>A View to a Kill</i>                |
| WNE   | <i>The World Is Not Enough</i>         |
| YOLT  | <i>You Only Live Twice</i>             |

## Quantum of Smoothness: Bond and Spatial Desire

Claus-Ulrich Viol

The representations of space in the Bond film franchise serve a larger purpose than simply providing a backdrop for the action and the characters. As already in Fleming's novels, space in the films is often spectacular and extreme. It is highly recognisable yet excitingly out of the ordinary, all the while remaining – as some would say – utterly predictable. Its obvious narrative and ideological functions make space integral to the workings and meanings of the films, for instance providing the audience with special visual pleasures and terrors or with ideological messages about the benefits of 'civilisation' and certain ways of ordering the world. 007 has been called a defender of empire, the world's policeman, a super tourist, and a pioneer and symbol of globalisation (Black 3; Baron 144–5; Pankratz 133; Tesche v); he is continually crossing, (re)conquering, and consuming all sorts of space.

It is probably no surprise that most critical readings have focused on the many problematical aspects of the representations of space in Bond. The construction of global space in both the Bond books and films has been termed Manichean, racist, imperialist, Orientalist, ethnocentric or reactionary. Michael Denning (221–3) has argued, with respect to the Bond novels, that they rework traditional racist and imperialist ideologies in a narrative code of mass tourism, constructing the countries Bond travels to, which are usually located on the so-called pleasure periphery, as either idyllic paradises (for Bond to enjoy), more authentic cultures (for Bond to study and exploit) or sources of threat and upheaval (for him to fight). Others have commented on the novels' obvious design to imaginarily reverse Britain's actual imperial and international decline (Bennett and Woollacott 28), and even those who have found, on a post-structuralist note, that Bond forms his British identity only in "spaces of alterity" point out that this cannot be simply understood as propagating the value of hybridity but that it rather conforms to conventional imperialist patterns (Pankratz 132).<sup>1</sup> The films, in which Bond has become a representative of the Western world in general, have drawn similar criticism. It has been noted that, in them, foreign countries are mostly reduced to some of their famous and more spectacular landmarks (the Eiffel Tower, the Golden Gate Bridge, the Rio carnival), that local interests and politics are usually not accorded any serious role (Black 204), and that – despite the films' more

1 The most optimistic reading of the racial and ethnic politics of Bond is offered by Halloran, who argues that Fleming's texts, far from promoting the values of racial purity, are obsessed with ethnic and cultural hybridity and portray Bond, his helpers, and the villains as all being geographically displaced and of mixed descent, thus indirectly promoting "new rules for [...] understanding across difference" (171). However, even Halloran struggles to get to grips with Fleming's heavy ethnic stereotyping and Bond's 'discriminating' chauvinism.

ambivalent characterisation of foreign characters in a bid to appeal to international audiences – ethnic and national others are still neatly classified and ordered in terms of the threat or use they present to the British/Western self (Baron 141).

As in the novels, there is a clear pattern governing which places are offered as positive, attractive spaces, which are cast as menacing, which may be both, and which represent a kind of spatial norm. Looking at the roles most black or Asian characters play in the films or the way certain locales invariably figure as the spaces of barbarity (Africa and Caucasia) or the exotic (the Caribbean and the Egyptian desert) one cannot help noticing that the “power-geometry” (Massey 149) underlying the representation is far from symmetrical. In view of these fundamental asymmetries, the fact that in the films there is also a lot of self-stereotyping, self-parodying, and – most recently – an increasing blurring of the boundaries between home and abroad, centre and margins (Pankratz 138) – as some of the evil others turn out to come from within – has been understood as a way of making the Bond films work in terms of international audience formations (Bennett and Woollacott 208). These are invited to read different national and political inflections in the films, while central ideological and latter-day imperialist values remain unquestioned: Bond’s Britishness may be sent up, but his Westernness hardly ever is.

However, while there is a lot to say for such readings, I would like to propose that the spatial politics and practices of Bond go beyond the repetition of stereotypes and the maintenance of dominant power structures, but – on the contrary – offer a vast potential to think and practise space in a radically different way. For this purpose, I suggest using the theoretical concepts of “smooth space” and “striated space” as developed by Gilles Deleuze and Félix Guattari in their seminal *A Thousand Plateaus: Capitalism and Schizophrenia* (1980). After presenting the rough outlines of their theory, I will discuss the possibilities and limitations of applying it to the Bond series in general, before I will go on to take a more detailed look at two examples. Comparing the first Bond film, *Dr No* (1962) with a more recent one, *Die Another Day* (2002), I will try to assess how their spatial constructions can be better understood with the help of Deleuze and Guattari and in how far, over time, there has been a change in the representation of space in the franchise.

For Deleuze and Guattari, “smooth space” is “in principle infinite, open and unlimited in every direction; it has neither top nor bottom nor center” (*Thousand Plateaus* 475–6). Occupied by nomads, it is characterised by fluidity, constantly shifting directions, and constantly modified distances. Striated space, in contrast, is the sedentary and quantified space of the *polis*, the state apparatus, and national capitalism. It is “necessarily delimited, closed on at least one side” (475), it is formed by things rather than filled by events, it is dimensional and metrically determined. Whereas in smooth space points and stops are subordinated to lines and trajectories of movement, in striated space it is the other way round: “lines or trajectories tend to be subordinated to points: one goes from one point to another” (478). This amounts to the difference between a

point lying between two vectorial lines and a line lying between two fixed points, connecting them, measuring their distance. Striated space is organised – in the literal sense of the term – as “one closes off a surface and ‘allocates’ it according to determinate intervals, assigned breaks” (481). Smooth space, on the other hand, remains a body without organs as “one ‘distributes’ oneself in an open space, according to frequencies and in the course of one’s crossing” (481). The smooth is the space where packs and nomads continuously divide and multiply, occupy space provisionally, and change directions at will, being influenced in their decisions by the tactile relations they entertain with one another or the nature of the journey itself.

Deleuze and Guattari discuss a number of what they call “models” (*Thousand Plateaus* 475) embodying the abstract distinction between the two spaces: with cloth texture it is the difference between striated fabric and smooth felt; with games it is the difference between chess and Go; with the physicosocial organisation of human life it is the difference between work/leisure and free action. In terms of geographical space proper, they see forms of empire and modern city space as prime manifestations of the striated, contrasting them with the smooth space of the sea, desert, steppe or ice (479).

Before I will proceed to apply the notions of smooth and striated space to a reading of the Bond formula, three important points still have to be added. First, according to Deleuze and Guattari, the two spaces they have identified in the abstract in fact exist only in mixture. Second, there is a continual confrontation and complex exchange between the two as smooth spaces are constantly being transformed into striated spaces, while striated spaces are constantly being reversed, returned to smooth spaces. The early striation of the sea through astronomical systems of navigation and the organisation of the desert may be seen as examples of the former, while the growth of the desert may be seen as a form of the latter process. Here it is important to note that striation creates homogeneity where before – in the smooth – there was heterogeneity, multiplicity, and formlessness, all of which are strongly favoured by Deleuze and Guattari. The growth of the smooth on the striated, on the other hand, disorganises space again and holds the potential for “deterritorialization” (*Thousand Plateaus* 480).

Third, and rather important in the context of discussing Bond and space, the smooth may not altogether be what it seems once it has been touched by the forces of striation. Deleuze and Guattari point out that striation frequently reimparts smooth space, turning it into mere functions or effects of itself. In this context, they mention the perpetual motion of strategic submarines that roam the seas in neo-nomadic movement, outflanking all gridding, only for the purpose of controlling striated space more completely. By the same token, the metropolitan centres of the world – which are the very model of striated space – produce processes of smoothing, if far from positive ones, both within themselves and on a global scale. While many of these power centres produce sprawling, temporary shantytowns and legions of homeless working against striation on their inside, on the outside they link up with other nodal points of “integrated world capitalism,” where “the multinationals fabricate a kind of deterritorialized

smooth space in which points of occupation as well as poles of exchange become quite independent of the classical paths to striation" (Deleuze and Guattari, *Thousand Plateaus* 492) which would have shaped and centred earlier city, nation, and empire building. This new space is primarily characterised by the fact that, in it, flows of capital reach unprecedented speed and freedom of movement. All of this, the two theorists remind us, shows "that the smooth itself can be drawn and occupied by diabolical powers of *organization*" (480).

What role, then, does 007 play with respect to these "diabolical powers of *organization*"? Is he an agent of striation and territorialisation? Or is he committed to smoothing and deterritorialisation? Or is he a double agent whose mission is to produce shiny surfaces of deterritorialised smooth space that are, however, subtly striated in the interests of capital and Western ideologies? Before I will make the case for Bond as an agent of smoothing, I shall briefly address the most obvious points arguing for spatial striation. One is that Bond's seemingly free movements are ultimately controlled by his secret service HQ, personified by M and centred in London (there is no film in which Bond is not in touch with or even called home at some stage). Another one is that Bond hardly ever goes any place that has not already been thoroughly striated (note how much he always relies on the latest navigational technology and the increasing role played by digital mapping and tracking devices).

A third point in favour of the claim of striation is that the representation of Bond's global movements usually privileges the stops at the expense of the journey itself. Bond normally travels from one more or less clearly defined destination to the next, moving rather like a hotel-hopping globetrotter than a nomad.

A fourth point arguing for striation is that Bond, like the nuclear submarines policing the seven seas, may outflank striation for himself, but in the end works on behalf of even stricter striation and territorialisation. Bond's mission usually is to thwart the villains' attempts to redraw the existing territorial boundaries in their favour. These acts of illegitimate reterritorialisation, it could be argued, have as their ultimate aim even a kind of deterritorialisation proper – i.e. world domination – and involve already in their early stages the setting up of a network of counter-spaces lying outside controlled territory; the villains' lairs are mostly situated on secluded mountain tops and islands or water-craft evading localisation.<sup>2</sup> Once Bond has managed to defeat the villains' attempts, what remains is a world restored not (or not only) to its previous striations but also to the political geometry largely championed by Anglo-American or Western interests.

A last and more formalist point could be raised to the effect that the narrative structure of the films, the way a limited number of what Umberto Eco has called "play situations" (254) are perpetually recycled and recombined, resembles the closed space of

2 For the role of islands and spaces outside safely controlled territory in the Bond films see Stockey 60–8.

chess, the regulated moves of its coded pieces. Thus, it could be argued that the very form of the representation of space in Bond – the way certain spaces have certain functions and positions in the narrative sequence – is heavily striated as well.

While none of these points can be written off easily, I would argue that they alone fail to account for the full complexity underlying the construction of space in the Bond series. Bond's spatial exploits, I would rather suggest, should be understood as the practices of Deleuzian "desiring-machines" (Deleuze and Guattari, *Anti-Oedipus* 1), while the spatial work of the franchise, through the representation of the activities of its hero as well as its style and manner, seems to me to speak to our desire to expand, connect, and create.

For Deleuze, desire is not grounded in lack, in a loss that we need to overcome, in negativity (as suggested by Lacanian and also Freudian psychoanalysis), but is a productive, positive, and creative energy; a process of increasing expansion, connection, and creation; a pre-personal "flow that passes across, destroys and dissolves structures, terms and identities" (Colebrook 104). A desiring-machine is the outcome of any series of connections, it is the site where new relations are produced, difference multiplies, and life forces are actuated. If desire is thus not produced by lack, it in its turn does not produce fantasies of any kind (especially not of the wish-fulfilling, compensatory kinds of fantasy that Bond films are often seen to express and cater to: to be as sexually attractive and powerful as Bond, to be as free in one's movements etc.). All investments of desire are social, not individual or self-serving, and the production of desire is production itself (Buchanan 49). The Bond series testifies to such a conceptualisation of desire on a number of levels (e.g. through its very serialisation and Bond's proliferation into other life forms, through its high degree of intertextuality and its diegetic representation of Bond's fairly 'desireless' desire and pleasure-seeking),<sup>3</sup> not least with respect to the construction and filming of space and mobility. The Bond films, I would argue, produce spatial desire as an anti-Oedipal, smooth flow.

What is the main evidence pointing to Bond as a factor of spatial smoothing, de-territorialising, and desiring? A lot of it is related to the anarchic potential that comes with his job as a secret agent (Palmer 136–56; Merry 222–4). Thus, it is striking that Bond manages to travel freely across all territorial borders, that he, too, passes across, dissolves, and – if necessary – destroys identity boundaries. In many ways, he seems

3 "I am not what you'd call a passionate man," Bond says to Emilio Largo in *Thunderball* (1965 [1:10:01]). And, indeed, from a psychological point of view most of Bond's actions are surprisingly non-motivational. We hardly see him wanting or wishing for (i.e. 'desiring,' in the everyday use of the term) objects and experiences. He may undergo temporary periods of lack and deprivation (such as when he is kept from his adversaries' secret or is confined by them), but, apart from this, his is a world of plenitude. Women, gadgets, food and drink are all there for his taking. What is more, he does not take a particular interest in them as such: a character trait that is frequently ironised, for instance, through his disregard for Q's inventions or his complaints about having to bed yet another beautiful woman ("Oh, the things I do for England!"). It is this impersonal, disinterested interest that makes him resemble a desiring-machine.



to be a nomad, a hunter-gatherer: Bond does not have a proper home,<sup>4</sup> the paths of his journey are not predetermined but develop from the encounters and relations he has with the other travellers he pursues or tries to escape, and he inhabits a space that is characterised by the collapse of the work-leisure division of striated space. Bond acts freely. There is no knowing where work for him begins and pleasure ends: his life seems to be a Vodka Martini between a kill and a seduction. As he is constantly on the move, restless, it can be argued that his stops are simply relay points between his trajectories of movement, and that the latter will always predominate.

Bond may be an agent in the service of the state apparatus, which Deleuze and Guattari relate to striation, but he is not *of* it, not tied to its rules and regulations. He has the licence to kill, to go against the very laws the state is built on, existing on its outside. Although his policing efforts cannot be read as lasting acts of deterritorialisation – as usually once he's finished, spaces have been reterritorialised – he himself always remains on the outside of all territorial state formations; his existence in fact collapses the difference between any inside and outside. This makes him an example of what Deleuze and Guattari have called "the war machine" (*Thousand Plateaus* 351), which they think operates in smooth rather than striated space. War machines are that which is excluded, which has excluded itself or which comes into existence in the process of modern state formation. These are forces that run counter to the central values of the bourgeois nation state, its forms of control and its regimes of production, the latter of which have subjected to themselves all forms of pleasure and excess. The war machines bring "a *furor* to bear against [measure], a celerity against gravity, secrecy against the public, a power against sovereignty" (352). Fighting against the packs, bands, and worldwide organisations that threaten the conservatism, self-preservation, and moderation of the state with their constantly shifting, excessive, and destructive nature, Bond closely resembles the war machines he is up against.<sup>5</sup>

While Bond depends on instruments of striation to find his bearings, large parts of the films are set in what has been singled out by Deleuze and Guattari as prime examples

4 The short scenes that take place in Bond's strikingly hotel-like rooms at the beginning of *Dr No* (1962) and his more conventional flat at the beginning of *Live and Let Die* (1973) are the exceptions that prove the rule. Filmic Bond's homelessness is thrown into relief when his situation is compared with that of Fleming's 007, whose home and housekeeper are described at length, or that of other action film heroes like Ethan Hunt (from the *Mission Impossible* series), Superman, Batman or Spiderman.

5 This comparison is also drawn by Frenk and Krug (204–5), who see Bond as a war machine that is let loose and used by the state apparatus, but can never be quite contained by the latter. They point out that the state's attempts to contain Bond regularly fail at the end of the films (when he is frequently shown in wide, unlimited spaces cutting his connection with his home base), and – shrewdly – add that what cannot be achieved in the diegetic world of the film is, however, attempted on an extra-diegetic level, for instance when a last image of free-floating Bond is framed by titles that try to firmly anchor him in a national context of film production: "Pinewood Studios, London, England."

of smooth spaces: the jungle, the desert, the steppe, the ice, and – especially prominent in Bond films – the sea.

However, the most important point in my argument here is the particular nature of smooth 007's spatial desire. As we have seen, striation is almost identical with an everyday understanding of space as "a container or field of points" (Colebrook 86) – for Deleuze and Guattari, this means that the dynamic intensities of life have been reduced to static units and coordinates which seem to have clear relations to one another. Yet, they argue, desire invests intensities, not persons or things, subjects or objects. For Bond in his wanderings, too, it seems that not objects, points, and possessions are important, but the intensities of life, the feel of the connections and disconnections he makes; or rather: of the connections that happen to him. Bond and his audience relish the speed, the leisure, the style of travelling, the taste of the drinks, the evanescence of his cross-cultural encounters, the particular visual qualities of the sites/sights they see. It is this foregrounding of intensities that runs counter to Bond's acts of striation and may well be held to be the most significant bit of spatial work carried out by the series.

Seen from a Deleuzian perspective, it is also Bond's supposedly clear-cut and unchanging identity that dissolves before our eyes. There is not one Bond. And Bond is not even so much a "mobile signifier" (Bennett and Woollacott 42) signifying different meanings in different contexts, as has long been argued, than either a multiplicity of signifiers or no signifier at all. He could be understood as a multitude of singular events repeating each other, always similar, yet always slightly different, each a momentary actualisation of a number of fluid intensities, whose coalescences as character traits are usually held to be precise identity markers. A succession of actors have played the role of Bond, each one giving their own face, body, voice, manners to the character. Note how his Englishness has, for instance, been found to be inflected by the different class and regional backgrounds of the actors that have come to be Bond (Green 83–8). Then there is the question of Bond's age and personal development: across the different films, there is no unilinear progression, but a discontinuity, a halting and mixing up of chronology that defies common-sense logic, representational realism, and our usual ideas of personal identity formation. Each actor in each film is Bond; each is a different Bond, though. Add to this the many Bonds of the books (by Fleming and his imitators), the film parodies, the computer games, the advertising industry, and the fact that they all relate to and differ from each other in diverse ways, but also exist side by side. In Deleuze's terms, then, Bond first and foremost is not and does not signify. He is continually becoming (with each new film and each new actor, for instance) and he is continually producing (other Bonds or social formations such as Bond fan clubs, for instance).<sup>6</sup>

<sup>6</sup> For another reading of Bond as a Deleuzian machinic assemblage, see O'Donnell 63–7, who focuses on the odd mixture of Bond's simultaneous overdetermination and underdetermination as

There is a distinct sense in which Bond's shape-shifting nature, his constant becoming, his lack of a substantive identity, personality, and psychology are linked with the surface markers of repetitive sameness (the seemingly same way of ordering the drinks, the 'same' tuxedos, the 'same' signature tune) to create a character that is purely external and thus discourages *identification* but supports a perception of the film in terms of intensities, quantities, events, movements. What Deleuze and Guattari have to say about Kleist's celebration of the war machine in his *Penthesilea* (1808) may equally well hold for the 'emotional' effect of the Bond films:

feelings become uprooted from the interiority of a 'subject,' to be projected violently outward into a milieu of pure exteriority [...]: love or hate, they are no longer feelings but affects. And these affects are so many instances of the [...] becoming animal of the warrior. (*Thousand Plateaus* 356)

That said, the full force of these affects in Bond is always slightly held in check by the films' ambiguous juxtaposing of processes of smoothing and striating as well as the complex interlacing of the different levels at which the filmic texts work. The smooth spaces and Bond's very acts of smoothing represented by the films are frequently shot through with references to striation, as can be seen, for instance, in the scenes involving the Union Jack parachutes in *The Spy Who Loved Me* (1977) and *Die Another Day* or Q's hot-air balloon in *Octopussy* (1983). Both parachutes and balloons can be considered to be among the 'smoothest' means of transport, yet in all cases their full potential is obscured or contained by combining them with a dominant signifier of nationhood. In *The Spy Who Loved Me*, there is even some graphic containment when the parachute, in the opening shots of the following credit sequence, is caught between the hands of one of Maurice Binder's models and replaced by titles announcing "Roger Moore as Ian Fleming's James Bond" (0:08:01) and another Union Flag waving in the background. In *Octopussy*, there is some ironic banter between Bond and Q about the steerability of the balloon, but in the end the latter also clearly acts as a means of surveillance and conquest. The most intricate instance of pitting smooth against striated occurs in the parachute jump of *Die Another Day*, when, in an inter-textual reference to *The Spy Who Loved Me*, hyper-English Gustav Graves out-Bonds Bond, only to be exposed as the shape-shifting Korean officer Tan-Sun Moon. This turns the jump into an act that is suspiciously over-coded as British/English, while revealing the film's surface striations to be undercut by smooth spatial and identity flows. Acts of smoothing and striating in Bond thus take place or oscillate along a continuum, they never exist in isolation.<sup>7</sup> A diachronic perspective on the films, however,

a subject and the way he is always on the brink of becoming inhuman or animal, "suspended between the (human) past and the (cybernetic) future" (67).

- 7 Apart from taking place at textual, paratextual, and intertextual levels, the phenomenon of inscribing striations on Bond's smoothing of space can also be found, contextually, in the way the films are used, responded to, and take effect in the real world. The audience that leapt on their seats and cheered on seeing the unfolding Union Jack parachute on *The Spy's* premiere night in the Odeon were certainly not celebrating Bond's stunt for its 'smoothing' potential. Similarly, audiences world-wide will overlook all conflicting evidence (internationally sourced gadgets, un-

shows that in the more recent ones, the balance is tilted in favour of smoothing, rather than striation.

Comparing *Dr No* with *Die Another Day* with respect to the nomadism they exhibit, we can see that in the first Bond film, 007 largely moves within and creates striations, whereas space in the later film is much more smooth – as it is, in fact, in all Brosnan Bonds. In *Dr No*, Bond's investigations take him only to Jamaica, which is clearly marked out as such, and the island of Crab Key, whose beach and swamp (episodes) have some touches of smoothness but where *Dr No*'s futuristic and strangely out-of-place base of operations is more a site of counter-striation than of openness and flux. In addition, Bond's whole mission remains centred in the stately London headquarters of the MI6. In the end, he does little more than re-incorporate *Dr No*'s territory, an illegitimate counter-empire, a no-place, into the legitimate imperial system to which it rightfully belongs and on whose behalf he acts.

The spatial politics of *Die Another Day* are much more complex. Bond's investigations take him to places as far apart as Korea, Hong Kong, Cuba, and Iceland. What is more, a lot of the spaces represented lack specificity and are not part of our usual maps. There are vast stretches of no man's land that we learn are supposed to be the North Korean demilitarised zone and a surreal palace of ice in unmarked white expanses somewhere in Iceland. Not to forget the last twenty minutes of the film, which are set on board a plane free falling somewhere over East Asia. The mode these spaces are represented in can only be called a-mimetic: the settings evoke the virtual realities of video games, simulacra of space rather than 'real' places. Bond's notorious parachuting-cum-surfing stunt after the villain has lasered off the edge of the ice cliff he is clinging to in his race car is only the most extreme example of such smoothing. Bond rides the crest of the wave of molten ice into nowhere, out of nowhere (and this time, the parachute cloth does not even have a Union Flag pattern). Add to this the general foregrounding of acts of (gratuitous) destruction of spaces and places, by both Bond and the villain. Gustav Graves's laser beam creates huge fields of conflagration, Bond explodes a clinic and melts the ice palace; before, both have bulldozed large parts of a restricted area in the Korean jungle. These acts can be read as material annihilations of striated space, as attempts to create chaos or the smooth in its place (significantly, the destructive laser beam threatens the camps of friends and foes). In contrast to Bond's spatial centring in *Dr No*, in *Die Another Day*, even the British, American, and Korean command posts have themselves become 'nomadic' and deterritorialised as they are often on the very spot of the action.

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gentlemanly behaviour, Scottish actor and accent, etc.) to be able to persist reading Bond as quintessentially English, while the films' smooth representations of real places has had some highly striating effects on the latter (as, for instance, in the case of Phuket, which turned into a tourist destination after *The Man With the Golden Gun* [1974] and today boasts a James Bond Island). My argument here is that, despite such obvious tendencies to process the films in terms of conventional striation, the audience's investment with the films is in the smooth, i.e. the instances of a spatial smoothing that holds the appeal of the less known, the liberating, and the transgressive.

Why do the more recent films flaunt plots and images of spatial smoothing? Is there an increased need in today's audiences for compensation as their own spatial experiences are more and more restricted by the forces of striation or do the films reflect a general global increase in flows of people, goods, and information – a real-life smoothing and opening-up of the world? I would like to end on an optimistic note here: for some, the films may represent compensatory fantasies, for others they may be nothing more than the very commodities that are exchanged on the globally expanding neo-liberal markets for which they provide ideological justification – still, for me, they also seem to contain in the quantum of smoothness they offer a part that has not been fully drawn by the ideologies of capitalism and Western dominance. They articulate spatial desires that are more fundamental than the wish to demarcate, parcel, occupy and consume territory, and they create, in articulating the desires of large international audiences, a transgressive potential that may be used to subvert the increasing commodification of spaces. Admittedly, this may only be a small quantum. On the last pages of *A Thousand Plateaus*, even Deleuze and Guattari remind us that a smooth space is never enough to save us – but, then, we can be sure that James Bond will return.

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## From the Costa del Sol to the Moon: James Bond and Tourist Locations

Susanne Schmid

1950s and 1960s British cinema was strongly influenced by the kitchen-sink realism of films like *Look Back in Anger*, the screen version of John Osborne's stage drama (1956), directed by Tony Richardson. If some films from those decades – Jack Clayton's *Room at the Top* (1959), an adaptation of John Braine's novel (1957), is another example – focused on serious issues like social mobility and sexual morality (Russell 181) while favouring bleak northern spaces and dreary, unappealing interiors, it is hardly surprising that the visual excess, the spectacle of the early Bond movies attracted crowds of viewers and contributed to the rise of Bondmania. The Bond films represent a visual move from 1950s postwar austerity to a 1960s consumerism that aimed at self-fulfillment and pleasure (Bennett and Woollacott 204–30). Therefore, the transformation from Ian Fleming's novels into films, into colourful visions, enhanced Bond's spectacular qualities, which became one of the most noteworthy characteristics of the entire series (Bennett and Woollacott 164). The manifold attractions of the charismatic hero and his improbable endurance tests have been heightened by the exotic locations, many of which are not within the financial reach of the majority of the audience. While most of the first Bond movie, *Dr No*, is set in the Caribbean, namely on Jamaica (where Fleming had his own retreat) and on the fictitious Crab Key, settings strongly imbued with colonial reminiscences, other Bond movies are far more global (Allan). Although Fleming himself travelled much when he was working for British intelligence during World War II, his activities and contributions towards espionage were largely desk-bound, whereas Bond, his creation, uses spectacular locations as theatres of action (Lycett 101–58).

Bond's unlikely plots have always at least in part been set in holiday locations desired by the many but affordable only to the few. If, to the average 1960s cinema-goer, locations like the Costa del Sol, the home of seaside mass tourism (Barke and Towner) with its grey hotel façades in Torremolinos and Malaga, were becoming realistic aims of desire, Bond's global business often led him to elite luxurious spaces where he has been rubbing shoulders with elite consumers: clubs, expensive hotels, and beautiful beaches not accessible to the common tourist. As mass tourism eventually opened up remote and exotic spaces to the average traveller, the locations of the Bond movies became ever more varied and, in *Moonraker*, even took the audience into space. This paper aims to analyse the use of locations, especially holiday locations, focusing on some early Bond films: *Goldfinger* (1964), *The Spy Who Loved Me* (1977), *Moonraker* (1979), and the two versions of *Casino Royale* (1967, 2006). The spoof *Casino Royale* (1967), which many film critics at the time decried as chaotic, highlights some ab-



surdities of the canonical Bond films and therefore serves as a useful contrast, while the 2006 version of *Casino Royale* will help to point out recent changes in the choice of venues. Bondian tourist spaces, mentioned in every analysis but often subsumed under other categories such as class, gender, and nationality, deserve an analysis that links current theoretical approaches (Eco; Foucault; Augé; Baudrillard) to the actual spaces shown on screen. One of the few pieces of criticism that link Bond to the tourism industry is an article by Michael Denning (64–8). Bond's world-wide privileged travelling leads him to expensive hotels, scenery, and architectural sights, where he uncovers cached villains who reside in and act from the folds of globally accessible tourist resorts, while Britain, the home ground, epitomised through M's office space, stays at the very centre of each film.

### Theorising Bond's "Unreal" Spaces: Formalism, Heterotopia, and Excess of Space

Ever since Umberto Eco's well-known structuralist analysis of Fleming's novels,<sup>1</sup> which contains many observations also applicable to the films, academic Bond criticism has made use of Eco's criteria. Eco's observation that the subject matter only "allow[s] a limited number of permutations and reactions" ('The Narrative Structure' 101) has led critics to uncover such "permutations and reactions" with the appearance of each new Bond movie. The interactions between select characters or groups of characters – for example, Bond and women, Bond and the villain, or Britain vs. non-Anglo-Saxon countries – have shaped nearly every analysis. Since Bond, serial lover and serial killer, is more or less immune to neurosis, the move from a psychological method to a formalistic one is, as Eco argues, necessary ('Narrative Structures' 36). In other words: the subject matter seems to demand an analysis in the spirit of formalism, which has always counted the consideration of space among its prior concerns. Eco not only lists the oppositions between the "Free World" and the Soviet Union as well as between Britain and the non-British rest of the world as two of 14 relevant oppositions, he also declares "Journey" to be one principal situation ('Narrative Structures' 36; 'The Narrative Structure' 105; Denning 64). The film industry has transformed this narrative formula into a "producer's formula" (Bennett and Woollacott 166) by employing spectacular locations as a major recurrent feature.

In his essay 'Of Other Spaces' (1986), Michel Foucault argues that "the present epoch will perhaps be above all the epoch of space" (22). Likewise, Yuri Lotman points out that all cultural models use space (123–214). These observations are in line with what has recently been termed the 'spatial turn' in cultural studies and takes into account that, as Joachim Frenk remarks in his introduction to a collection of essays (2000),

1 Umberto Eco's famous and much-cited article exists in several versions, which are not identical: Eco, 'The Narrative Structure in Fleming' (1966) and Eco, 'Narrative Structures in Fleming' (2003). Kingsley Amis's analysis is also concerned with formula fiction.

there is no "disinterested representation of space" (12).<sup>2</sup> As the Bond films are a collection, an anthology of accessible and non-accessible spaces, of paradisiacal landscapes as well as fantastic high-tech fortresses, James Bond has access to what the French anthropologist Marc Augé has termed "excess of space" (25), which he proposes as a condition of supermodernity, of globalisation, of our world's medialisation.

To return to Foucault's terminology: Bond movies are "heterotopias" because, in the French philosopher's words, they are "capable of juxtaposing in a single real place several spaces, several sites that are in themselves incompatible" (25). Bond films are topological fantasies and take their super-mobile hero through a most unlikely succession of spaces. Many of the glossy venues Bond visits are in turn heterotopias, too, since they are privileged places not accessible to the many, often merely temporal spaces (such as hotels), to which not everyone is granted admission. In these heterotopias, Bond performs his lethal professional activities as well as his private mission of sexual virility while displaying lifestyle and consumerism. Bond's performances happen in spaces away from his home, in spaces that are, again in Foucault's words, "elsewhere" (24). And while the tourism industry enables the average traveller to visit more exotic places, the Bond locations move further towards the unreachable.

The Bond settings are situated between the recognizable real and the fantasmatic, the unreal, they are "hyperreal" (174) in the words of Jean Baudrillard, the theoretician of medialised "realities," who claims that the reflection or pretence of reality (of the kind we find in Bond movies), is characterised by an excess of reality, truth, and conformity, is "more real than real" (191).<sup>3</sup> The Bond films radicalise this principle by carefully adhering to factual details (buildings, local ambience, foods), while locating impossible actions in these "real" places. Thus, the producers' careful attention to detail leads the audience of the Bond films into the seductive space of "hyperreal" locations, which combine characteristics of the real and unreal, and thus are more than real and unreal at the same time. They are places to which one may pay visits every day without ever being able to access them in truly Bondian style.

### The Tourist Spaces Shown in the Five Selected Films

These are the locations shown in the five selected films:

*Goldfinger* (1964): Mexican drug baron's base, Miami Beach, London, golf club (Kent),<sup>4</sup> Switzerland, United States (near Fort Knox)

2 For a survey of current discussions, see Döring and Thielmann.

3 Baudrillard's concepts of the "simulacrum" and the "hyperreal" are mapped out in 'Simulacra and Simulations' and 'Fatal Strategies,' both in *Selected Writings*, while his reflections on space can be found in *America*. See also Merrin 28–44.

4 The location of filming was Stoke Poges golf club (Buckinghamshire).

*Casino Royale* (1967): France, Scotland, London, Mata Bond's temple, London, Berlin (Mothers' Help), France/Casino Royale, London, Casino, Jimmy Bond's headquarters, Casino

*The Spy Who Loved Me* (1977): The sea, Moscow, Austria, the sea, desert Egypt, Cairo, Nile, train, Sardinia, Mediterranean

*Moonraker* (1979): Airplane, London, California (company), French castle in California, Venice, Rio, Brazil, outer space

*Casino Royale* (2006): Prague, Uganda, Madagascar, yacht, London, Bahamas, Miami, Montenegro, Lake Como, Venice, Lake Como

### Tourist Locations

Denning's article 'Licensed to Look' (2003) deals in part with Bond's locations and adequately labels the spy a "superior" as well as "privileged" tourist (66–7). Bond is an individual sometimes prefiguring, sometimes following in the footsteps of mass tourism. The early scenes of *Goldfinger*, for example, are set in the famous Fontainebleau Hotel in Miami, a popular vacation hotel for the rich and famous in the 1950s. That this is "the best hotel in Miami Beach" (0:09:09) is stated by Bond at the beginning of the episode set in the luxurious abode. While the film pays much attention to luxurious detail, situating Bond in the immediate vicinity of a social and financial elite, it nevertheless also presents the hotel as a huge vacation complex, a high-class version of the holiday spaces to which 1960s tourists aspired when travelling for example to the Costa del Sol. Other locations such as the elite Ocean Club on the Bahamas (*Casino Royale*, 2006) and the fashionable and expensive Cala del Volpe on Sardinia (*The Spy Who Loved Me*, 1977) are more reminiscent of club holidays, which became popular in the 1980s. The current return of style is mirrored by the high-class Montenegro hotel, where Bond stays in *Casino Royale* (2006). Through the excessive attention paid to luxurious detail, these hotels transcend the distinction between the real and the unreal: Since the cinematic audience can visit them, they are real, yet they are unreal because hardly any movie-goer will be able to afford them. They are real as they host wealthy tourists, yet unreal because whoever visits them is extremely unlikely to encounter characters such as the dead girl covered in gold paint or the violent African warlords, the cheated investors of *Casino Royale*. These hotels are the backdrop for sexual, culinary, and sporting activities, during which Bond, served by a host of waiters and concierges, is meant to gather strength before chasing yet another villain. However, these hotels have real as well as metaphorical backdoors through which the murderous miscreant will enter; they are mere façades, illusions that enable the hero to engage in the consumption of luxury while the villain, and eventually evil as such, is established as inevitable. Thus, the hotels are not only real/unreal in the sense of Baudrillard, they are non-places, mere transitory passages. Augé provides an entire list of such contemporary non-places, which are temporal and ephemeral and

thus resemble Foucault's heterotopias: "airports and railway stations, hotel chains, leisure parks, large retail outlets," likewise "means of transport," places where performances of self take place, which resemble one another.<sup>5</sup> As settings, the Bond hotels are exchangeable, near-identical in their lack of precise identities.<sup>6</sup>

If the world-wide similarity of big hotels is a truism of international tourism, scenery, untouched landscape, traded as 'unique' by local and national tourist boards, is also subjected to the global medialisation of desirable spaces. Some opening sequences of the Bond movies present beautiful panoramas, thereby prefiguring the visual luxury that is to come: *The Spy Who Loved Me* begins with a ski chase and a parachute jump in the Austrian Alps, while *Tomorrow Never Dies* (1997) commences with an arms bazaar in the remote mountains on the Russian-Afghan border. If such natural habitats are unique, they nevertheless grow exchangeable as the initial panoramic view is established as a visual prop. Often, the scenic views either metamorphose into theatres of violent action, or they lead the protagonists into such scenarios, as the Swiss roads of *Goldfinger*. If Bond's elite travelling eventually turns into ruthless attacks on and defenses of territory, the films nevertheless retain some of the more leisurely tourist pursuits traditionally associated with scenery, particularly the activity of looking. Both Bond and the movie audience follow the tourist pastime of seeing and of being seen. When, in *Goldfinger*, the action has moved to Switzerland, we see Bond's car stopping above Goldfinger's, who enjoys the view, while a third party, Jill Masterson's sister, intent on revenge, joins the activities of looking and discovering. This classic tourist activity of looking is accompanied by gazes which aim for more than tourist satisfaction and turn the panorama into the site of a chase, and, eventually, of death. The gaze is often connected to power: whoever looks first is able to shoot first. Frequently, the gazers, those looking at the landscape, or searching one another, are intruders into the local panorama – but not always. *Dr No* commences with a murder carried out by three local men, who pretend to be blind; as they are discovered to possess sight, they kill. So the question "Can the subaltern speak?" might be rewritten as "Can the subaltern look?" to which the answer is: "Yes, he can, and it's murderous!"

The films also show architectural landmarks and ancient monuments, which, in a global and medialised world, are exchangeable against one another. If Bond's searches regularly uncover new villainous high-tech spaces, they do not lead to new discoveries of ancient architecture. Bond only goes to well-established sites, to the already known: St. Mark's Square in Venice, the Egyptian pyramids, and other world-famous tourist 'brands.' These places are so well-known that they are no longer 'real' sites belonging to one culture, they are medialised world culture. One example is Hugo Drax's French-style mansion in *Moonraker*, which has been imported to California, as the helicopter pilot, Corinne Dufour, explains: "The Drax residence. Every stone brought

5 Augé 64. My thanks go to Ann Gardiner (Lugano) for pointing out this reference.

6 Bond is frequently depicted as passing through airports and other entry points, which Virilio has described (85).

from France. Cute, isn't it?" (0:12:35).<sup>7</sup> California also happens to be the home of the first Disneyland Park, which is, in Baudrillard's words, "a play of illusions and phantasms" (174), and therefore resembles Drax's abode. The mansion is genuine in the sense that it has been brought from France, is built from genuine French masonry, uncanny in its attention to detail, yet it is unreal because it is decontextualised; it reenacts French aristocratic power out of context. The comment "Cute, isn't it?" made by a French woman and with a French accent, Americanises and globalises French culture. When Drax and his friends go hunting, their imitation of European aristocratic mores is more real, more European than anything else Bond discovers on his trip. Past grandeur is also present in the Egyptian locations of *The Spy Who Loved Me*, a film which pursues the visual strategy of minimising human agents by letting them appear next to huge buildings (pyramids, the Egyptian temple) or technical achievements (Atlantis, the Liparus). Moreover, Egypt, a former super power, mirrors the past greatness of the British Empire but also, rather anachronistically, reintroduces Britain as a quasi-imperial power in the Middle East as if the loss of face during the Suez Crisis of 1956 had never happened. A move away from the use of landmark architectural sites as backdrops for chases occurs in the 2006 version of *Casino Royale*, which begins in the military camp of a Ugandan warlord and then moves on to a Madagascar building-site. Although Madagascar possesses tourist areas, the film presents a non-tourist site of monumental size, which allows numerous unexpected and acrobatic stunts. Thus, the construction site metamorphoses into a performative heterotopia where 'other' rules apply. As it is an unknown space, non-existent in countless medialised images, it becomes, paradoxically, more 'real' than the French mansion or the pyramids.

Since the updating of the Bond formula is a standard practice in all films, spaces reappear, for example Venice and St. Mark's Square, shown in *Moonraker* and in *Casino Royale* (2006), albeit in different ways. In *Moonraker*, where gadgets are all-important, Bond becomes involved in a deadly chase through the Venetian waterways yet escapes in a gondola, which, thanks to Q's ingenious high-tech devices, turns into an amphibian vehicle that allows Bond to tour St. Mark's Square and to position himself at the very centre of tourist attention. The crowd's stares pay tribute to the world-famous spy, who even eclipses Venetian monuments. In *Casino Royale*, St. Mark's Square is the backdrop of the revelation that Vesper, in whom Bond had trusted, has been cooperating with the enemy, "the Organisation" (Campbell, CR 2:11:09). In a wild hunt, Bond induces the collapse of a neighbouring derelict building by puncturing the rafts which support its structure, thus also causing Vesper's death. While the collapse of the building is shown to engage the attention of those close to the incident, it attracts far less attention than Bond's gadgety vehicle in *Moonraker*. If, in the *Moonraker* episode, Bond himself is at the centre of attention, collecting admiring gazes without even looking back, the collapse of the palazzo in *Casino*

7 The castle, Vaux le Vicomte, is situated in France (not in California) and has repeatedly been used for filming.

*Royale*, Vesper's trapping in the lift, and her subsequent death occur when Bond is on his own, has to face himself alone. In *Casino Royale*, none of the mastery of the St. Mark's Square scene of *Moonraker* is left. If, in earlier Bond films, the final smashing of architectural constructions merely concerns the villain's high-tech hideout, *Casino Royale*, filmed after 9/11, ends on a "spectacle of urban disaster" (Jarvis 61).

Given the popularity of the Bond films, it is hardly surprising that one early parody dating from 1967, the rather episodic version of *Casino Royale*, also presents a wide range of locations. Its opening scene shows a meeting between Inspector Mathis and Evelyn Tremble alias James Bond in a French public toilet, that is, in a place that carries no social prestige at all, barely the expected tourist site. The audience can only catch sight of the two men's heads. Having introduced himself as a member of the secret police, Mathis pulls something we cannot see out of his trousers, stating: "These are my credentials" (Huston, *CR* 0:00:28), to which Tremble/Bond replies: "They appear to be in order" (0:00:31). This opening scene, like others in Bond movies, has a gender bias, privileging masculinity while debunking the spy's posing and caricaturing his sexual exploits. Chalked on the wall of this public toilet is the word "zizi," which is children's slang for 'penis' and contributes to the ironic debunking of Bond's over-sexualised masculinity, which is additionally questioned through the homoerotic subtext of a scene in which two men expose their genitals to one another. The French ambience is further denoted by children who are singing 'Frère Jacques.' The elite tourist pursuits of the other Bond films have metamorphosed into an encounter with everyday France and a visual and acoustic display of the ultimate result of sex for everybody apart from Bond: children. To return once more to Foucault's and Augé's concept of space: toilets are also heterotopias or non-places, and therefore on the same level as Bond's expensive hotels.

## Britain

Although the tourist places Bond visits have one feature in common, namely that they are rarely British – *Thunderball* (1965) is an exception – Britain and its greatness are nevertheless at the very centre of all Bond films. It is noteworthy that Fleming's novels and the films treat displays of British power and vulnerability in different ways: In the novel *Moonraker* (unlike in the film), the lethal rocket is to impact "within a hundred yards of Buckingham Palace" (137), a prime tourist location, the heart of the nation, the very core of the British Empire, of Western rule, of civilisation. In the novels and films, M and his office space, the wooden panels and leather-bound books, sometimes even maritime images, appear as the focal point of Britishness (Stock). That this space can be transferred to Egypt's ancient monuments (*The Spy Who Loved Me*) or to a Brazilian monastery (*Moonraker*) proves that despite the loss of the status of a world power, Britain is still omnipresent in places of international crisis. The episodes in M's temporarily exported office reveal that an export of Q's gadgets has taken place, too: Both in Egypt and in Brazil, the lethal weapons are well-hidden in

items of everyday use, have in fact been combined with local folkloristic items. A waterpipe metamorphoses into a gun in Egypt, while a crouched Brazilian figure with a sombrero hides a machine gun. This folklorisation of high-tech equipment occurs parallel to the product placement that happens in the films and favours British, American, European, occasionally Japanese brands and thus items produced by major industrial nations. If Bond's watches conceal weapons and lasers, can email, print off messages, and act as cameras, they are also expensive status symbols by companies like Seiko. In *Moonraker*, a chase, which occurs before the scenic backdrop of Rio de Janeiro, climaxes when a nameless and faceless enemy crashes into a British Airways billboard that ironically carries the words "We'll take more care of you" (1:09:48).<sup>8</sup> Items and individuals associated with Brazil and Egypt appear to be in need of technological development through Britain, the technologically more advanced state. British technical superiority also means that local items can no longer be manipulated by locals after they have gone through Q's hands. A fine example is the BMW in *Tomorrow Never Dies*, which Elliot Carver's men cannot destroy in Hamburg because the British – that is, Q, – have enhanced its safety.<sup>9</sup>

Moreover, Britishness symbolises lifestyle and is therefore emulated, for example by Drax, who employs an English butler with the aristocratic name of 'Cavendish' and, while quoting Oscar Wilde, celebrates and praises British afternoon tea as a cultural achievement (*MR* 0:15:33).<sup>10</sup> He unwittingly exposes his own barbaric understanding of this afternoon rite when feeding raw meat to his dogs while enjoying the sophistications of the tea ceremony himself. One of his deficiencies is his failure to understand the 'genuine' British lifestyle, which he regards as a mere surface, and therefore he can never be more than a bad imitation of the dandy-spy. Like his master Drax, the henchman Jaws, Bond's comic antagonist, succumbs to the attractions of British style and imitates Bond's dandyism. When, during a wild car chase, his car drives off a cliff and crashes through the roof of a local farmer's house, Jaws emerges covered in dust and, in a truly Bondian gesture, concentrates on rearranging his jacket. As in the *Harry Potter* films, Britishness is reduced to a handful of characteristics, afternoon tea, clothing, style, and sold to an international audience (Schmid).

Not only technologically less developed countries but also the United States need Britain, or, to be more precise, Bond, to solve their problems. In *Dr No*, Bond uncovers who is interfering with the American space program at Cape Canaveral, while in *Goldfinger*, he alone can save the United States' gold supply in Fort Knox from being contaminated by a dirty bomb. Bond's opposite number in the CIA, Felix Leiter, who appears in several movies, is no rival for Bond, neither as a man nor as a spy (see Frenk and Krug). Leiter has hardly any opinion of his own to voice and mainly serves

8 On Rio de Janeiro, used as a location also in other Bond movies, see Freire-Medeiros.

9 This may be an allusion to and comic inversion of Audi's slogan "Vorsprung durch Technik" ("Advancement through Technology"), broadcast in British TV commercials in the early 1990s.

10 Amis muses: "Politically, Bond's England is substantially right of centre" (95).

the purpose of either agreeing to what Bond says or of equipping him with financial and logistic aid. Britain is thus on more than equal footing with other world powers. Bennett and Woollacott have called Bond "a hero of the NATO alliance" (99), yet he is more: he is living proof of Britain's superiority over all other allies, in fact, he is a late colonial hero. Since Bondmania began when Britain had lost its political power, the movies are also a spatial fantasy providing the illusion of the ever-present, ultra-competent British government official. Frequently, the films allude to the colonial past: among *Dr No*'s Jamaican settings are Government House and the Queen's Club, while in Egypt, Britain proves that her government elite is still active when it comes to vital issues. If the colonial settings in the Bond films are exchangeable against one another, what really counts is the British presence, which reestablishes law and order and conveys the notion of the Empire as a "benign" institution (Winder 23).<sup>11</sup>

### Cached Villains

James Bond has been a global player since the 1960s, long before the term 'globalism' had gained notoriety. If some of his antagonists work for Eastern powers, like Auric Goldfinger, who is backed by Red China, other films play down the Cold War and let the central antagonist appear as a "sovereignty-free actor," as David C. Earnest and James N. Rosenau astutely argue (88). Such "sovereignty-free" agents thrive "within the folds of the sovereign state system," that is, they are active in areas not fully or not at all regulated by states such as international trade, terrorism, organised crime, the media. The villain is usually a singularly negative hero, very successful, surrounded by a mostly faceless army of supporters, and in possession of spectacular hideouts, which are geographically situated somewhere in the folds of officially known spaces.

The visual style of the villain's hideout is at least as important as the murderous narrative. Stromberg's fantastic construction Atlantis in *The Spy Who Loved Me*, an example of 1970s design, can hide in and appear out of the Mediterranean. The Drax mansion, situated next to his technological complex in California, is uncanny in its imitation of European architecture. Both Drax and Stromberg use their places as façades to hide somber high-tech inventions designed to empower them. The villainous spaces have two sides, they are dualistic both in terms of appearance and in terms of ethics: One side of them is opulent, stylish, luxurious, and pleasant, like the hotels in which Bond prefers to stay. In extravagant Atlantis, the villain Stromberg not only presides over a huge dinner table but also enjoys the artistic pleasure of Renaissance paintings and tapestries on the wall. Some of these props in Atlantis, likewise the artifacts in the Drax residence, look as if they have been taken out of museums. Like Fleming's readers, who occasionally find themselves exposed to minute descriptions, the movie audience has sufficient time to admire these items, whose presentation

11 Winder's study focuses on the decline of the Empire as a background for Bondmania. On the tradition of the imperialist spy-thriller, see Bennett and Woollacott 82–6.



interrupts the main action – a mode of presentation which Eco calls the “technique of the aimless glance” (‘Narrative Structures’ 51) and which is employed both in the novels and in the films. Classical music and the opulent display of beautiful marine life cater for the audience’s tourist desires by transporting connotations of aesthetically pleasing and stylish entertainment. In Baudrillard’s concept, it would be the opulence of details which causes Stromberg’s dwelling to be “hyperreal.” The other side, the sombre part of the villainous territory, is a clinical high-tech space, operated by robotic supporters, which can appear and vanish suddenly, like the Venetian laboratory in *Moonraker*. This laboratory, like the huge ship Liparus in *The Spy Who Loved Me* and Drax’s space station, operate outside the geographical and political confines of a sovereign state. The luxurious façades only mock art and culture since they do not ennoble the villain, they do not even make him more human. On the contrary: Stromberg, for example, enjoys the luxuries of Atlantis (food, music, marine life), while his female assistant and the two scientists who have previously worked for him are cruelly murdered at his command, in fact, for his voyeuristic pleasure. Therefore, the smashing of these double-sided spaces at the end of the films appears as morally justified. If most Bond movies end on the cinematic spectacle of the destruction of the villain’s hideout, *Casino Royale* (2006) replaces this plot element by the mere crumbling of an ancient building, thus adding psychological depth, since the unnecessary wounding of the city confronts Bond with his own emotional wounds, who, having caused Vesper’s death, has acquired villainous attributes as well.

### Movements, Vehicles, Sports

Tourism relies on transport, and so does James Bond, who, however, has always travelled much faster and has visited far more places than the ordinary tourist. James Bond is a supertourist, one of the first global players *avant la lettre*, and his seemingly effortless geographical mastery of space reflects the British Empire’s geographical scope. The main instrument of this spatial mastery is Bond’s use of gadgety cars, which symbolically express British superiority. The first such car was the famous Aston Martin in *Goldfinger*, followed by one or several vehicles in nearly each subsequent film. Bond’s cars are always fast and expensive models – for example, a Lotus Esprit in *The Spy Who Loved Me* – with that certain extra equipment that enables them to dive, jump, move by remote control, eject unwanted passengers, throw pursuers off their tracks, and fire at them. Bond’s vehicles are the opposite of the ships, submarines, and planes that go astray. Only Q’s ingenuity as well as Bond’s make the cars what they are to the audience: icons of Bond’s invulnerability. Frequently, the vehicles serve the purpose of making elaborate chases possible, like the motorcycle chase in *Tomorrow Never Dies*. If the women drivers or pilots of the first films are exposed to laughter, like Pussy Galore and her Flying Circus, a phalanx of ridiculously independent women (Ladenson 421), the representation of later female protagonists is

in line with societal developments and, like the scientist Dr Goodhead in *Moonraker*, they appear as competent when steering a vehicle or flying a plane.

James Bond is not only a first-rate driver and pilot but also a skilled sportsman and thus embodies the muscular British public school ethos when excelling at skiing, diving, hang-gliding, parachuting, golf, and other expensive sports not readily available to the masses. Like his driving, his sports activities express British national superiority, as in *The Spy Who Loved Me*, where the first chase of the film occurs in Austria: having proved to be a better skier and a more skilled marksman than his fierce Russian opponents, Bond opens his parachute, a Union Jack, and gracefully floats through the Alpine landscape, which serves as a backdrop to yet another British military achievement. Likewise, in *Moonraker*, the “gentleman playboy” (Dargis) masters the sky and the territory through hang-gliding. Bond, who barely ever excels at team sports, re-individualises sports and travelling. Only in *Thunderball*, he is one of a team of divers which engages in an underwater fight with another team, yet we never see him playing football, basketball, or any other team sport of the kind an ordinary movie audience would enjoy watching or participating in. The new Bond, in contrast, is less overtly national and therefore, in *Casino Royale*, quite happily goes swimming.

### Tourists in James Bond's Footsteps

Where does Bond's supertourism leave its breathless audience? The Bond movies have a huge internet fandom with numerous websites, some of which list and describe the locations. Moreover, a recent guidebook by Martijn Mulder and Dirk Kloosterboer provides detailed background information on the locations for anyone wishing to travel in Bond's footsteps. Bond, it seems, is able to make a location: the island of Khao Tapu in *The Man with the Golden Gun* acquired the name ‘James Bond Island’ through the film. Hotels, which have played host to Bond like the Fontainebleau Hotel in Miami Beach, or the Ocean Club (see ‘James Bond Ocean Club Suite’) on the Bahamas have been quick to use this fact for their own marketing, describing the – in fact medialised – experience of the Bond movies as the true, authentic experience that other tourists may wish to emulate. Individuals in pursuit of the Bond experience can participate in Bondian actions without incurring any of the lethal dangers: recent fans may engage in indoor skydiving to re-experience one of the stunts of *Quantum of Solace* (2008) at Bedford, or they may rent an Aston Martin (Kelly). If Bond the tourist has become ‘the real thing,’ such marketing of ‘reality’ expresses a nostalgic desire that motivates the production of the “hyperreal.” Our experience of revisiting his places of action through films, online, or in person can only ever be an imitation, constitutes a simulation of simulations.

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## Travelling with Ian Fleming: From *Thrilling Cities* (1963) to James Bond

Kirsten Sandrock

Travelling is part of the James Bond formula. The secret agent usually goes abroad to complete his missions at locations that, at first glance, seem to be either glamorous or ominous. At second glance, they usually turn out to be both. On the one hand, this rite of travelling plays into "the secret-agent fantasy [of] being totally portable" (Amis 14) and, on the other hand, it asserts 007's Britishness in opposition to the foreign cultures he visits. A similar ambivalence of going global while actually remaining local can be seen in Ian Fleming's travelogue *Thrilling Cities Part 1 & 2* (1963). This two-volume travel account was originally written when the *Sunday Times* asked Fleming in the late 1950s to travel through Asia, North America, and Europe and to write a column about the major metropolises he visits. These columns were later republished in book form by Jonathan Cape as *Thrilling Cities Part 1* and *Thrilling Cities Part 2*<sup>1</sup> and served as major inspiration for Fleming's choice of setting and characters in his later novels. Moreover, the travelogue yields important insight into the author's self-invention as real-life counterpart to his fictional hero James Bond. And yet, *Thrilling Cities* belongs to the crudely understudied parts of Bond criticism.

The following essay tries to counteract this gap by looking at the intertwinement of reality and fiction in Fleming's travelogue and his Bond adventures. It will be argued that *Thrilling Cities* must be read as part of the Bond texts and not, as it is usually done, as one of Fleming's non-fiction books.<sup>2</sup> This argument will be based on an analysis of a three-fold interaction between art and life in *Thrilling Cities* and selected Bond works: first, the author's stylization in his travelogue as an alter ego of James Bond; second, the interaction between Fleming's travels and his novels, in particular *The Man with the Golden Gun* (1965) and *You Only Live Twice* (1965); and third, the influence *Thrilling Cities* had on the larger James Bond industry, especially the movie version of *You Only Live Twice*, which was produced after Fleming's death and yet features major elements of his travelogue. Taken together, these three levels of

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1 A complete American edition, published by Signet Books, followed in 1965, which also included the previously unpublished short story '007 in New York.' See Fleming, Ian, *Thrilling Cities*, complete and unabridged edition. New York: Signet Book, 1965. All quotations in this essay are taken from this edition.

2 Fleming's other non-fiction texts are *The Diamond Smugglers* (1957), in which Fleming investigates the global smuggling operations emerging from Africa, and an account of the Kuwait oil industry, which, however, was never published and only survived in manuscript form. For further information on the latter text, see Lycett 376–8.

interaction illustrate the inseparability between reality and fiction in the cultures of Bond and assert the value of *Thrilling Cities* as another 007 case study.

The first tour Fleming made on behalf of the *Sunday Times* took him to Hong Kong, Macao, Tokyo, Las Vegas, and New York with stopovers in Beirut and Bombay. A second tour followed one year later, in 1960, when Fleming travelled the major cities of Europe, including Hamburg, Berlin, Vienna, Geneva, Naples, and Monte Carlo. The glamour of these destinations goes hand in hand with the ways in which Fleming's travels were marketed as genuine James Bond adventures. The cover page of the British edition of *Thrilling Cities Part 1* features a set of pictures that show half-naked women, casino tables, and scenic coastlines while spelling out the publisher's promotion strategy with the slogan: "Ian Fleming, creator of James Bond, takes you on an off-beat tour of the flesh-pots of Far Asia and America" (n.p.). The British edition of *Thrilling Cities Part 2* then simply leaves away the "flesh-pots" and promotes the book as taking readers "on an off-beat tour of Hamburg, Berlin, Vienna, Geneva, Naples and Monte Carlo," which is supported by images of white horses, the Mediterranean coast, a stylish lady singer and, in reference to recent European history, a picture of soldiers marching on an open field (n.p.). In addition, both covers reprint a *Daily Telegraph* quotation maintaining that "This is James Bond's world," which is underscored by reviews reprinted on the back cover that liken *Thrilling Cities* to James Bond (n.p.). Similarly, the American edition quotes several critiques that compare Fleming's travelogue with the Bond novels, for instance "A Bonded tour of fourteen sin-infested cities..." or "It's almost as much fun as 007 battling SMERSH" (n.p.). This marketing strategy of correlating *Thrilling Cities* with the world of James Bond already indicates the first level of interaction between Fleming's life and art, namely the author's re-invention as another kind of Bond figure. His publishers do not stress his journalistic qualities or his experiences as a traveller but play on his image as a writer of spy novels, which is exactly what Fleming himself does when he sets out to write his travelogue.

In the beginning of *Thrilling Cities* Fleming reflects upon his initial reaction to the *Sunday Times* proposal, which he accepted with a mixture of excitement and uncertainty about his role as a travel writer. His opening passage reads like an attempt to preclude all expectations of him as a serious tourist and stresses instead the notion of entertainment that is supposed to serve as guiding principle for his travelogue:

If you write thrillers, people think that you must live a thrilling life and enjoy doing thrilling things. Starting with these false assumptions, the Editorial Board of the *Sunday Times* repeatedly urged me to do something exciting and write about it and, at the end of October 1959 they came up with the idea that I should make a round trip of the most exciting cities of the world and describe them in beautiful, beautiful prose. (Fleming, *Thrilling Cities* 11)

The passage brings forward the oppositional tendencies underlying *Thrilling Cities*, which claims to be an authentic travel account at the same time as it is fabricated as a prose story. Although Fleming outwardly distances himself from the "false assumptions" about his thriller writer's life, he really endorses this image and adds to

the fictionalization of his persona when emphasizing his ability to render the world in "beautiful, beautiful prose." Fleming thus takes on a dual role as travel writer who continues to write fiction. In his 'Author's Note,' he further proclaims that he has always "been interested in adventure, and [...] the *frisson* of leaving the wide, well-lit streets and venturing up back alleys in search of the hidden, authentic pulse of towns" and hypothesizes: "It was perhaps this habit that turned me into a writer of thrillers, and by the time I made the two journeys that produced these essays, I had certainly got into the way of looking at people and places and things through a thriller-writer's eye" (*Thrilling Cities* vii). These repeated references to his novelistic abilities demonstrate the author's unwillingness to abandon the fiction genre even when writing an apparently non-fictional travelogue. What he does is to take on the role of a real-life James Bond and to act the part that is usually played by his famous hero. As a result, Ian Fleming becomes as much an alter ego of his fictional creation as his fictional creation had previously been an alter ego of the author.<sup>3</sup>

*Thrilling Cities* was never meant as a tourist guidebook but rather as another adventure story in the guise of non-fiction. In order to achieve the right balance between authenticity and eccentricity, Fleming worked together with his travel editor Leonard Russell, who praised the author's "extraordinary personality" that emerged from the pieces and the way he presented himself as "part sensational journalist, part diehard old clubman, part ruthless revolutionary, the whole adding up to a unique and endearing eccentric" (qtd. in Pearson 376). Fleming did his best to keep up this image that likens him to his Bond character when writing about his travels. He stays in expensive hotels, dines in fancy restaurants, spends his evenings in bars and casinos and meets some of the most famous criminals in the cities he visits while largely refraining from mentioning any cultural or artistic highlights of a city. The only recommendations Fleming makes fall into the categories of hotels, eating places and night-life locations, which plays perfectly into the author's image as notoriously bad tourist.

In contrast to any serious travel writer, Fleming emphasizes his dislike of all touristic aspects of travelling. In the opening pages of *Thrilling Cities* he cheerfully proclaims that he "was the world's worst sight-seer and [...] had often advocated the provision of roller-skates at the doors of museums and art galleries" (11). Fleming's nonchalant attitude towards travelling is reconfirmed by his wife Anne, who once "remarked that

3 The autobiographical influence of Fleming's life on the Bond character has frequently been discussed and is usually taken for granted. Even though John Atkins asserts that "Fleming was annoyed if anyone identified him with Bond or addressed him as such" (72), critics like LeRoy Panek state that "Bond's habits are Fleming's habits" (218) while John Pearson concludes: "James Bond is not really a character in this book. He is a mouthpiece for the man who inhabits him" (235). Similarly, John Pearson argues that "James Bond is simply Ian Fleming daydreaming in the third person" because in fiction Fleming could "imaginatively embark upon the most hazardous of missions, armed with little more than bravery, resourcefulness and that all-important 'licence to kill' which Commander Ian Fleming RN had never actually enjoyed in real life" (259, 3).



she was not sure how he made a city 'thrilling' because he never stopped to look at anything" (qtd. in Lycett 370). The sense of complacency that transpires through Fleming's indifference to sightseeing is, of course, exactly what his readers and publishers expected from him. John Pearson confirms that the success of the first *Thrilling Cities* series was not based on its usefulness as a travel guide but rather on the "superficial, jet-travel glimpses of the world [that] exactly echoed the quirky, restless temperament of the reporter, disclosing his ability to skim the exotic and the odd from the unlikeliest as well as the likeliest places" (376). Fleming himself was fully aware of these expectations others had of him as a thriller writer and admits at one point: "I felt I must try and keep up with my hero" (*Thrilling Cities* 50). What Fleming describes here is the increasing *bondification* of his own life. He is no longer simply a novelist but a public figure whose existence is measured according to the standards he has set in his fiction.

The second type of interaction between Fleming's travels and his Bond stories is a reciprocal one. On the one hand, *Thrilling Cities* served as important influence in terms of character and setting on the Bond novels Fleming wrote afterwards. On the other hand, Fleming's travel accounts also drew on previous 007 adventures and, in some cases, even substituted fiction for reality. An example for the first kind of fusion between tourist reality and fiction is a comparative reading of Fleming's *Thrilling Cities* account of Macao and his novel *The Man with the Golden Gun* (1965). Although the later Bond story is set in Jamaica, it nevertheless draws on Fleming's earlier experiences in Macao, especially his meeting of the notorious "gold king of the Orient [...] the enigmatic Dr Lobo of the Villa Verde in Macao" (*Thrilling Cities* 29). From the beginning onwards, Fleming had been fascinated by the mixture of glamour and crime that evolves around the gold industry in Macao: "Gold, hand in hand with opium, plays an extraordinary secret role" in "the whole underground traffic" of this "tiny Portuguese possession" (28). Accordingly, he was "[i]rresistibly attracted" by the figure of Dr Lobo and, having arranged a meeting with him, "gravitated towards him, the internal Geiger counter of a writer of thrillers ticking furiously" (29). However, when Fleming meets Dr Lobo he is utterly disappointed by him. There is no secret aura surrounding the figure, no cloak-and-dagger appearance, not even a feeling of suspicion that would allow Fleming's thriller writer's imagination to run wild:

What had I learned of Dr. Lobo, the gold king whose name is whispered with awe throughout the East? Absolutely nothing at all. What do I think of Dr. Lobo? I think that while there may be unexplained corners in his history, as there are in the histories of many a successful millionaire, he is what he appears to be: a careful, astute operator who has chosen an exotic line of business which may have caused a good deal of pain and grief in its retail outlets to the regret, no doubt, of the wholesaler. (Fleming, *Thrilling Cities* 39)

But if Fleming is disappointed with the actual character of Dr Lobo, then he uses this disappointment to rework the man into a much more thrilling figure in his fiction. The villain Scaramanga in *The Man with the Golden Gun* (1965) is equally intelligent and industrious as Dr Lobo but, in contrast to the actual figure, he is also charismatic

enough to kill his enemies with a gun and bullets made of pure gold.<sup>4</sup> Scaramanga is surrounded by the very air of mystery that Fleming had expected from Macao's gold king, and it is his legend that is brought to life in *The Man with the Golden Gun*.

An example of the reverse type of influence, namely that of the earlier Bond texts on Fleming's travel writing, can be seen in the author's account of New York City in his travelogue. New York is the final stop on his first *Thrilling Cities* tour and the one he least enjoys, as the author makes plain:

It was my last lap and perhaps I was getting tired, but each time I come back [...] I feel that it has lost more of its heart. Steel and concrete, aluminium and copper sheathing for the new buildings, have smothered the brownstone streets that had so much warmth in the old days. The whole of the beautiful Washington Square area has disappeared, and up town the new resettlements areas – vast blocks of tiny apartments for the Negroes and the Puerto Ricans – have now overwhelmed Harlem. (Fleming, *Thrilling Cities* 104)

As a consequence of this disillusionment with the city, Fleming decides to substitute reality for fiction. He uses an excerpt from his short story '007 in New York' and thus manages to make his account of the city thrilling even though it really was not. The excerpt Fleming reprints in his travelogue introduces Bond as an icon of the very life the author himself had wished to lead but was denied during his stay in New York, as the following passage makes clear:

James Bond sat back and lit one of his last Morland Specials. By lunchtime it would be king-size Chesterfields. The Astor. It was as good as another and Bond liked the Times Square jungle – the hideous souvenir shops, the sharp clothiers, the giant feedomats, the hypnotic neon signs, one of which said BOND in letters a mile high. Here was the guts of New York, the living entrails. (Fleming, *Thrilling Cities* 111)<sup>5</sup>

Fiction here serves as substitute for reality and illustrates that, for Ian Fleming, the two were virtually interchangeable. He does away with clear-cut genre divisions and presents the story of his spy agent in New York as another form of travel-writing. It almost seems as if the author has converged with his fictional character, so that it no longer matters whether the figure in the story is called James Bond or Ian Fleming.

The third kind of interaction between Fleming's travels and the cultures of James Bond can be seen in a comparison of the account of Tokyo in *Thrilling Cities* and 007's adventure in Japan in *You Only Live Twice* (1964). At first sight, it appears as if

4 In arguing that Scaramanga is Fleming's fictional incarnation of Dr Lobo, I dispute Craig Cabell's contention that Dr Lobo served as the inspiration for Fleming's earlier novel *Dr No* (94). Not only did Fleming's visit Macao *after* his publication of *Dr No* in 1958, but the parallels between Dr Lobo and Dr No virtually end with the relation of their names whereas the resemblance between the "gold king of the Orient" (*Thrilling Cities* 29) and Scaramanga in *The Man With the Golden Gun* are palpable.

5 It is interesting to note that the British edition of *Thrilling Cities* lacks this passage from the short story. Here, Fleming's representation of New York City concludes with a disenchanting quotation from the *Nation* about the "ruthlessness of large-scale redevelopment" in the city as well as the prevalence of "crime," "violence," and the "degenerate generation" in this "sick society" (*Thrilling Cities* 108–9).

the travelogue only influenced the novel. In *You Only Live Twice*, Bond is ordered to go to Japan and to obtain secret information about the Russians from the Japanese. However, parts of the mission are contrived and serve as a means for M to find out whether Bond is still fit to work for the British Secret Service after his newly wedded wife Tracy had been killed by Ernst Stavro Blofeld less than twenty-four hours after their marriage in the preceding novel *On Her Majesty's Secret Service* (1963). What is interesting is that, on closer inspection, it appears as if Fleming's travel account had not only a direct influence on the novel *You Only Live Twice* but also an indirect one on the film of the same name that was released three years later in 1967. The movie includes several scenes relating to Japan and Japanese culture that can only be vaguely traced back to the original novel but are very similar to Fleming's account of Tokyo in *Thrilling Cities*.

Fleming's account of Tokyo begins with a highly sceptical passage about the place he is about to visit. The author regrets his leave-taking from Hong Kong, where he had thoroughly enjoyed himself, and admits that his attitude towards Japan is negatively charged for both personal and historical reasons:

I was full of reservations about Japan. Before and during the war they had been bad enemies, and many of my friends had suffered at their hands. But many other friends whose opinions I value love the country and its people, and my comrador, Richard Hughes, who came with me in the Comet and who, being an Australian, should have been predisposed against Japan, was totally enamoured of it. There was nothing to do but clear my mind of the splendours of Hong Kong and prepare myself for a great deal of hissing and bowing. (Fleming, *Thrilling Cities* 45)

In the end, Fleming neither loves nor loathes the city but retains an aloof attitude towards it. His descriptions of the place are often minute and pay attention to the details of Japanese culture, but ultimately he keeps an ironic distance to the place. Take, for instance, Fleming's description of his Tokyo hotel room. He states that the "room appeared to be made of plywood and rice-paper" and compares the floor's carpeting of "black-edged oblongs of rush matting" with "uninscribed mourning cards" (*Thrilling Cities* 47). Similarly, when he sees a "rough pottery vase containing a spindly branch of dwarf chrysanthemums" in his room, he does not try to understand the piece of traditional flower arrangement but dryly comments on this type of art: "Having read a B.O.A.C. leaflet about Japanese flower arrangement, I assumed that these twigs held some gracious message which was hidden from me" (47).

The same attitude of ironical indifference towards Japanese culture can be found in James Bond's experiences of Tokyo in the novel *You Only Live Twice*. Fleming's twelfth novel devotes long passages to the description of Japanese culture and traditions. Starting with a detailed depiction of geishas in the opening chapter, the novel represents Bond's mission as a mixture of political and cultural investigations. This becomes most apparent when 007 has to cover up as a Japanese fisherman in order to fulfil his mission of killing Blofeld. The latter hides as a botanist in Japan, where he cultivates a garden of poisonous plants that serves as a top-notch suicide place for people all over the country. With the help of his friend and colleague Tiger

Tanaka, Bond undergoes a complete physical and cultural makeover that allows him to enter the secret garden in the guise of a Japanese person. But even beforehand, the novel puts emphasis on the depiction of local traditions, using Tiger Tanaka as a cultural guide for Bond. He introduces the protagonist to the customs of a local bath, the non-existence of swear words in the Eastern culture and takes him to a traditional whore-house, where Bond complains – in the exact same words Fleming used in the excerpt from his travelogue only in reserved order – about the great “deal of bowing and hissing” (*YOLT* 99). In the end, Bond shows a similar attitude of casual disaffection towards the Japanese culture as Fleming does in his travelogue. He partakes in the local practices of the place but actually remains aloof from the underlying structures, as the example of his *haiku*-episode illustrates.

Tiger tries to introduce Bond to the particularities of Japanese literature and induces the latter to compose his own *haiku*. Instead of sticking to the traditional seventeen-syllable structure and trying to give it an ephemeral touch, however, Bond’s *haiku* ignores the fundamental principles of Japanese poetry and makes the verse all about himself: “‘You only live twice: / Once when you are born / And once when you look death in the face’” (Fleming, *YOLT* 101). The fact that this counterfeit *haiku* serves as title for Fleming’s novel is indicative of the casual manner in which Japan is represented in *You Only Live Twice*. Its surface is flashy, but the underlying meaning remains obscure.<sup>6</sup> The same attitude of casual disinterest can be witnessed in the scene in which Tiger serves Bond raw lobster. Being greatly “surprised when the head of his lobster began moving off his dish and, with questing antennae and scrabbling feet, tottered off across the table,” Bond initially voices his objection to eating the living animal but, when Tiger admonishes him for snubbing this Japanese delicacy, retreats to the rhetorics of satire to demonstrate his authority: “James Bond bowed ironically. ‘*Shimata!*’ he said. ‘I have made a mistake. It crossed my mind that honourable Japanese lobster might not like being eaten alive. Thank you for correcting the unworthy thought’” (89–90). Irony here functions as an instrument of cultural detachment, which subtly downgrades the Japanese practice of eating living animals and, with it, the entire code of honour practiced in the country. By means of language, Bond voices his alienation with the Eastern culture in a similar manner as Fleming had previously done in his travelogue.

In contrast to the novel, the film adaptation of *You Only Live Twice* (1964) adopts a different approach towards the representation of James Bond in Japan. Here 007 is praised by Tiger Tanaka for being “exceptionally cultivated [...] for a European” (00:30:40), as he knows the right drinking temperature of sake (98.4 degrees Fahrenheit) and feels overall comfortable in settings as different as Tokyo’s backstreets,

6 Fleming himself seems to have been well aware of this superficial representation of Japanese culture, as Lycett notes: “He admitted that he was not sure what Arthur Waley, the doyen of Oriental scholars, would have made of it. But he thought even his friend would glean some Japanese esoterica from it” (416).

Tanaka's ninja training camp or the sumo match he visits in the beginning of his stay. What is interesting is that the sites Bond visits in the film correspond almost exactly to the travel itinerary Fleming had set out for himself when first arriving in Tokyo. In his travelogue Fleming writes:

I wanted, I said, to [...] visit the supreme judo academy; see a sumo wrestling match; explore the Ginza; have the most luxurious Japanese bath; spend an evening with geishas; consult the top Japanese soothsayer; and take a day trip into the country. [...] Thanks to Dick and Tiger Saito, I achieved all these ambitions to the full, with the exception of the sumo wrestling bout which I was only able to see on television. (Fleming, *Thrilling Cities* 48)

The majority of these itinerary items can be rediscovered in Bond's travels through Japan in the film version of *You Only Live Twice*. Sean Connery's Bond visits a martial arts academy, spends time with geishas and even manages to watch a sumo match as if his fictional travels function as a late wish-fulfilment for Fleming, who had died three years before the movie *You Only Live Twice* was released.

It seems likely that Roald Dahl, who was a friend of Fleming and wrote the screenplay of *You Only Live Twice*, had read *Thrilling Cities* and drew on its representation of Japan when writing the film script. The strongest proof for this can be found in the scene when Tiger Tanaka invites James Bond to take his "first civilized bath" in his private home. Four girls dressed in white underwear come to greet the visitor, just as Fleming had been greeted by a woman who "wore nothing but the shortest and tightest of white shorts and a white brassiere" when he went to a Japanese bath in Tokyo (*Thrilling Cities* 53). In fact, the versions of Fleming's and Sean Connery's experiences in the Japanese bath could hardly be more alike. While the real-life author indulges in the fact that "sex is a delightful pastime" there, "totally unconnected with sin – a much lighter, airier affair than in the West" (*Thrilling Cities* 53), Sean Connery in *You Only Live Twice* is advised by Tiger that there are two golden rules in Japan when taking a bath. The first is, "Never do anything for yourself when somebody else can do it for you," and the second is, "In Japan, men always come first. Women come second" (0:32:20–0:32:31). This attitude of servility, too, can be traced back to Fleming's account of Asian women in *Thrilling Cities*:

Oriental ladies have an almost inexhaustible desire to please. They also have the capacity to make the man not only suspect, but actually believe, that he is in every respect a far more splendid fellow than in his wildest dreams he had imagined. Not only that, but the women of the East appear, and in fact actually are, grateful for one's modest favours, with the result that every meeting with them leaves one in good humour and with a better opinion of oneself. However ill-founded this feeling may be, how very different from the knocking we all get in the West where women [...] take such a ferocious delight in cutting the man down to size! (Fleming, *Thrilling Cities* 35)

If this excerpt sounds like taken out of Fleming's Bond adventures, then I would argue it is. Fleming's account of Asia in *Thrilling Cities* evidences the *bondification* of his life and illustrates that a clear-cut distinction between fact and fiction in the author's oeuvre is impossible. The different layers of interaction between Fleming's life and art are too manifold and complex to adhere to crude generic divisions such as that. Consequently, it is necessary to include *Thrilling Cities* in the larger field of Bond studies

and to acknowledge that the author turned as much into an alter-ego of his fictional character as his fictional character was created as an alter ego of the author. *Thrilling Cities* is an important document for Bond studies, not only as source and inspiration for the later novels but actually as another adventure of Commander 007 alias Ian Fleming.

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